

How This Deck Works

Universal Design for Learning · Multi-Tiered System of Supports

EVERY LEARNER · SAME FIRM GOAL

Multiple ways in

Every lesson opens with a real question and a clear “I can” goal, so you know why it matters and where you’re headed.

Multiple ways to see it

Direct instruction, primary sources, maps, and bilingual key vocabulary — the same ideas shown more than one way.

Multiple ways to show it

Model-with-me, sentence frames, and choices in how you respond — you reach the same goal by the route that works for you.

*Your teacher checks your progress along the way and gives you another path if you need one — **the goal never lowers.***

US.59

U.S.-Soviet Competition

TN STANDARD

US.59 – Describe the competition between the U.S. and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of NATO, SEATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

I CAN

I can describe the competition between the U.S. and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of NATO, SEATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

The superpowers competed without direct war — after 1945 the United States and the Soviet Union entered a decades-long rivalry through an arms race, economic competition, and proxy conflicts rather than open combat.

KEY POINT

The superpowers competed without direct war — after 1945 the United States and the Soviet Union entered a decades-long rivalry through an arms race, economic competition, and proxy conflicts rather than open combat.

Two systems clashed over how to organize society — American capitalism and democracy stood against Soviet communism and one-party control, and each side worked to spread its model across the postwar world.

KEY POINT

Two systems clashed over how to organize society — American capitalism and democracy stood against Soviet communism and one-party control, and each side worked to spread its model across the postwar world.

Rival alliances divided the globe — the U.S.-led NATO and the Soviet-led Warsaw Pact split much of the world into two armed camps, formalizing the confrontation that defined the Cold War.

ZOOM IN



US.59 · Military Alliances: NATO & the Warsaw Pact

Read Article 5 of the NATO Treaty — weigh who wrote it and why before you read the words.

WHO

North Atlantic Treaty Organization

WHEN

April 4, 1949

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

NATO Treaty (Article 5)

North Atlantic Treaty Organization · April 4, 1949

"The Parties agree that an armed attack against one or more of them in Europe or North America shall be considered an attack against them all and consequently they agree that... each of them... will assist the Party or Parties so attacked by taking forthwith... such action as it deems necessary, including the use of armed force."

[Avalon Project, Yale Law School](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.59:

The United States and its NATO allies, who gained collective security, and defense industries on both sides fueled by decades of arms spending.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.59:

Taxpayers who funded a massive arms race, and peoples of smaller nations turned into battlegrounds for superpower proxy conflicts.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.59:

The governments of the United States and the Soviet Union, whose leaders set alliance, arms, and foreign policy for two rival blocs.

Anchor: NATO Treaty (Article 5), North Atlantic Treaty Organization, April 4, 1949 (Avalon Project, Yale Law School)

Words you need before we read

Cold War

En español: *Guerra Fría*

WHAT IT MEANS

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Superpower

En español: *Superpotencia*

WHAT IT MEANS

A nation with overwhelming military, economic, and political power capable of projecting force globally; during the Cold War, only the United States and Soviet Union qualified as superpowers.

Capitalism

En español: *Capitalismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

An economic system based on private ownership, free markets, and competition, where individuals and businesses operate for profit, championed by the United States as superior to Soviet communism.

Check your understanding

Compare how the U.S. and USSR used economic aid and trade to compete for global influence during the Cold War.

- A** Both nations used economic assistance—like the U.S. Marshall Plan—to win allies, demonstrate their system's superiority, and expand their spheres of influence
- B** Only the U.S. provided economic aid to other nations, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which does not align with the documented historical record
- C** Economic competition was not part of the Cold War, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D** The USSR provided more economic aid than the U.S, which does not reflect the consensus among historians when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.60

Containment and Early Cold War Policies

TN STANDARD

US.60 – Explain the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

I CAN

I can explain the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

Kennan's Long Telegram defined the strategy — diplomat George Kennan argued Soviet expansion had to be met with firm, patient “containment,” giving the early Cold War its guiding policy.

KEY POINT

Kennan's Long Telegram defined the strategy — diplomat George Kennan argued Soviet expansion had to be met with firm, patient “containment,” giving the early Cold War its guiding policy.

The Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan put containment into action — the 1947 Truman Doctrine pledged aid to nations resisting communism, and the Marshall Plan rebuilt Western Europe's economies to keep them out of Soviet reach.

KEY POINT

The Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan put containment into action — the 1947 Truman Doctrine pledged aid to nations resisting communism, and the Marshall Plan rebuilt Western Europe's economies to keep them out of Soviet reach.

The Berlin Airlift held the line without firing a shot — when the Soviets blockaded West Berlin in 1948, the U.S. and allies flew in food and fuel for nearly a year, showing containment in action.



US.60 · The Berlin Airlift (1948-1949)

Read the Truman Doctrine Speech — identify the speaker, date, and purpose before you weigh his words.

WHO

President Harry S. Truman

WHEN

March 12, 1947

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

The Truman Doctrine Speech

President Harry S. Truman · March 12, 1947

"I believe that it must be the policy of the United States to support free peoples who are resisting attempted subjugation by armed minorities or by outside pressures. I believe that we must assist free peoples to work out their own destinies in their own way. I believe that our help should be primarily through economic and financial aid."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.60:

Western European nations rebuilt by the Marshall Plan and shielded by U.S. commitment, and West Berliners sustained through the airlift.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.60:

Peoples of Eastern Europe left under Soviet domination, and Americans who took on the burden of funding global containment.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.60:

President Truman and his advisers, who set containment policy, and Congress, which funded the Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan.

Anchor: The Truman Doctrine Speech, President Harry S. Truman, March 12, 1947 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Truman Doctrine

En español: *Doctrina Truman*

WHAT IT MEANS

President Truman's 1947 policy pledging U.S. support for nations threatened by Soviet communism, beginning with military and economic aid to Greece and Turkey, marking America's commitment to containing communist...

Marshall Plan

En español: *Plan Marshall*

WHAT IT MEANS

The massive U.S. program providing over \$13 billion in economic aid to rebuild Western European economies after World War II (1948-1952), designed to prevent communist expansion by fostering prosperity and...

Check your understanding

Why was the Marshall Plan successful in rebuilding Europe and preventing communist expansion?

- A** It provided only military assistance, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- B** It invested over \$13 billion in European recovery, strengthening economies, creating American trade partners, and reducing the appeal of communism in struggling nations
- C** It was a failure that weakened European economies, but the historical record tells a more complex story and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- D** It focused only on Eastern European nations, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.61

Second Red Scare & McCarthyism

TN STANDARD

US.61 – Analyze the causes and effects of the Second Red Scare, including: Americans' attitudes toward McCarthyism, blacklisting, and Julius and Ethel Rosenberg.

I CAN

I can analyze the causes and effects of the Second Red Scare, including Americans' attitudes toward McCarthyism, blacklisting, and the Rosenberg case.

Postwar fears fueled a hunt for domestic subversion — Soviet spying, the fall of China to communism, and the Soviet atomic bomb convinced many Americans that communists had infiltrated the U.S. government and society.

KEY POINT

Postwar fears fueled a hunt for domestic subversion — Soviet spying, the fall of China to communism, and the Soviet atomic bomb convinced many Americans that communists had infiltrated the U.S. government and society.

McCarthy made unproven accusations a political weapon — Senator Joseph McCarthy claimed to hold lists of hidden communists, and “McCarthyism” came to mean reckless charges of disloyalty made without solid evidence.

ZOOM IN



The Rosenberg case brought the fear to a peak — Julius and Ethel Rosenberg were convicted of passing atomic secrets to the Soviets and executed in 1953, in a trial that still fuels debate over guilt and Cold War hysteria.



US.61 · The Rosenberg Case

Read McCarthy's Wheeling Speech — consider who spoke it and why before you weigh the claims.

WHO

Senator Joseph McCarthy

WHEN

February 9, 1950

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Wheeling Speech

Senator Joseph McCarthy · February 9, 1950

"I have here in my hand a list of 205—a list of names that were made known to the Secretary of State as being members of the Communist Party and who nevertheless are still working and shaping policy in the State Department... The reason why we find ourselves in a position of impotency is not because our only powerful potential enemy has sent men to invade our shores, but rather because of the traitorous actions of those who have been treated so well by this Nation."

[U.S. Senate Historical Office](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.61:

Politicians like McCarthy who gained fame and power by exploiting fear, and those who used anticommunism to attack rivals and dissenters.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.61:

Thousands who lost jobs and reputations to blacklists on flimsy evidence, and the Rosenbergs, executed amid the era's hysteria.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.61:

Congressional committees, the FBI, and courts that pursued suspected communists, and Senator McCarthy, who drove the accusations.

Anchor: Wheeling Speech, Senator Joseph McCarthy, February 9, 1950 (U.S. Senate Historical Office)

Words you need before we read

McCarthyism

En español: *Macartismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The practice of making accusations of subversion or treason without proper evidence, named after Senator Joseph McCarthy who led aggressive investigations of suspected communists in the 1950s.

Second Red Scare

En español: *Segundo Miedo Rojo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The period of intense fear and persecution of suspected communists in America during the late 1940s and 1950s, driven by Cold War tensions and events like the Soviet atomic bomb and Korean War.

Blacklisting

En español: *Listas Negras*

WHAT IT MEANS

The practice of denying employment to people suspected of communist sympathies or refusing to cooperate with anti-communist investigations, particularly prevalent in the entertainment industry.

Check your understanding

How did Senator Joseph McCarthy's tactics initially gain support but eventually backfire?

- A** McCarthy never gained significant public support, which represents a common misconception about the period and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B** McCarthy maintained support throughout his career, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C** His accusations resonated with genuine fears, but his bullying tactics and baseless attacks on the Army exposed his methods as reckless and destructive
- D** His tactics were always viewed as inappropriate, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.62

Korean War

TN STANDARD

US.62 – Describe the causes, course, and consequences of the Korean War, including: Domino Theory, 38th parallel, Battle of Inchon, Entry of the communist Chinese, Final divisions of the Koreas.

I CAN

I can describe the causes, course, and consequences of the Korean War, including the Domino Theory, 38th parallel, Battle of Inchon, entry of communist China, and final divisions of the Koreas.

The domino theory drew the U.S. into Korea — fearing that one nation falling to communism would topple its neighbors, the United States led a UN force to repel North Korea’s 1950 invasion of the South.

KEY POINT

The domino theory drew the U.S. into Korea — fearing that one nation falling to communism would topple its neighbors, the United States led a UN force to repel North Korea’s 1950 invasion of the South.

MacArthur's Inchon landing reversed the war — a bold September 1950 amphibious assault at Inchon cut off North Korean forces and pushed the front back toward the Chinese border.

ZOOM IN



US.62 · Battle of Inchon (September 1950)

Chinese entry produced a bloody stalemate — when U.S. forces neared its border, China entered the war, and the fighting ground back to the 38th Parallel, ending in a 1953 armistice near the prewar line.

KEY POINT

Chinese entry produced a bloody stalemate — when U.S. forces neared its border, China entered the war, and the fighting ground back to the 38th Parallel, ending in a 1953 armistice near the prewar line.

Read Truman's Address on the Korean War — note the speaker, date, and purpose before you read his words.

WHO

President Harry S. Truman

WHEN

April 11, 1951

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Address on the Korean War

President Harry S. Truman · April 11, 1951

"The Communists in the Kremlin are engaged in a monstrous conspiracy to stamp out freedom all over the world. If they were to succeed, the United States would be numbered among their principal victims. It must be clear to everyone that the United States cannot—and will not—sit idly by and await foreign conquest."

[Harry S. Truman Presidential Library](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.62:

South Korea, which survived as a non-communist state, and the U.S. containment strategy, which held the line in Asia.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.62:

The millions of Korean civilians and soldiers killed, and American and allied troops who fought a costly, inconclusive war.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.62:

President Truman and the United Nations, who committed forces; and Truman, who relieved MacArthur to keep the war limited.

Anchor: Address on the Korean War, President Harry S. Truman, April 11, 1951 (Harry S. Truman Presidential Library)

Words you need before we read

Korean War

En español: *Guerra de Corea*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1950-1953 conflict in which communist North Korea (backed by China and the Soviet Union) invaded South Korea, prompting U.S.-led UN intervention in the first major "hot war" of the Cold War era.

Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Domino Theory

En español: *Teoría del Dominó*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Check your understanding

Why did Chinese entry into the Korean War change the conflict's course and duration?

- A** Chinese involvement had no significant impact, but the historical record tells a more complex story
- B** China supported UN forces against North Korea, but the historical record tells a more complex story
- C** Chinese entry quickly ended the war, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work
- D** China's 300,000 troops forced UN retreat, transformed a near-victory into stalemate, and extended the war by two years

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.63

Eisenhower's Cold War Policies

TN STANDARD

US.63 – Explain Cold War policies during President Dwight D. Eisenhower's administration, including brinkmanship and "peaceful coexistence".

I CAN

I can explain Cold War policies during President Eisenhower's administration, including brinkmanship and "peaceful coexistence."

Brinkmanship threatened massive retaliation — Eisenhower’s “New Look” relied on the threat of overwhelming nuclear response to deter Soviet aggression while holding down the cost of large standing armies.

ZOOM IN



US.63 · Brinkmanship & the “New Look”

Peaceful coexistence eased tensions at times — alongside nuclear threats, Eisenhower pursued cautious diplomacy and summit meetings, seeking to manage the rivalry and avoid direct war with the Soviet Union.

KEY POINT

Peaceful coexistence eased tensions at times — alongside nuclear threats, Eisenhower pursued cautious diplomacy and summit meetings, seeking to manage the rivalry and avoid direct war with the Soviet Union.

Two tools defined his approach to the Cold War — comparing brinkmanship with peaceful coexistence shows a president balancing deterrence and diplomacy to contain communism without full-scale war.

KEY POINT

Two tools defined his approach to the Cold War — comparing brinkmanship with peaceful coexistence shows a president balancing deterrence and diplomacy to contain communism without full-scale war.

Read Eisenhower's "New Look" Policy Speech — identify the speaker, date, and purpose before you analyze his words.

WHO

President Dwight D. Eisenhower

WHEN

January 12, 1954

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Eisenhower's "New Look" Policy Speech

President Dwight D. Eisenhower · January 12, 1954

"The basic decision was to depend primarily upon a great capacity to retaliate, instantly, by means and at places of our choosing... The way to deter aggression is for the free community to be willing and able to respond vigorously at places and with means of its own choosing."

[Dwight D. Eisenhower Presidential Library](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.63:

The United States, which deterred Soviet aggression while limiting military spending, and taxpayers spared the cost of huge conventional forces.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.63:

A world placed under constant threat of nuclear annihilation, and populations of nations caught in Cold War brinkmanship.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.63:

President Eisenhower and his Secretary of State, John Foster Dulles, who set nuclear-deterrence and coexistence policy.

Anchor: Eisenhower's "New Look" Policy Speech, President Dwight D. Eisenhower, January 12, 1954 (Dwight D. Eisenhower Presidential Library)

Words you need before we read

■ Brinkmanship

En español: *Política al Borde del Abismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War diplomatic strategy of pushing dangerous situations to the edge of war to force the other side to back down, associated with Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in the 1950s.

■ Domino Theory

En español: *Teoría del Dominó*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

■ Eisenhower Doctrine

En español: *Doctrina Eisenhower*

WHAT IT MEANS

President Eisenhower's 1957 policy pledging U.S. military and economic aid to Middle Eastern countries resisting communist aggression, extending containment policy to protect oil supplies and strategic interests.

Check your understanding

Compare brinkmanship and peaceful coexistence as Cold War strategies.

- A** Brinkmanship used nuclear threats aggressively while peaceful coexistence emphasized diplomatic competition—both aimed to avoid actual war while continuing ideological struggle
- B** Both strategies were identical in approach, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C** Neither strategy addressed nuclear weapons, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D** Peaceful coexistence was more aggressive than brinkmanship, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.64

Nuclear Fears and Civil Defense

TN STANDARD

US.64 – Explain the fears of Americans surrounding nuclear holocaust and debates over stockpiling and the use of nuclear weapons, including: Atomic testing, Civil defense, Fallout shelters, Impact of Sputnik, Mutual assured destruction.

I CAN

I can explain the fears of Americans surrounding nuclear holocaust and debates over stockpiling and the use of nuclear weapons, including atomic testing, civil defense, fallout shelters, Sputnik, and mutual assured destruction.

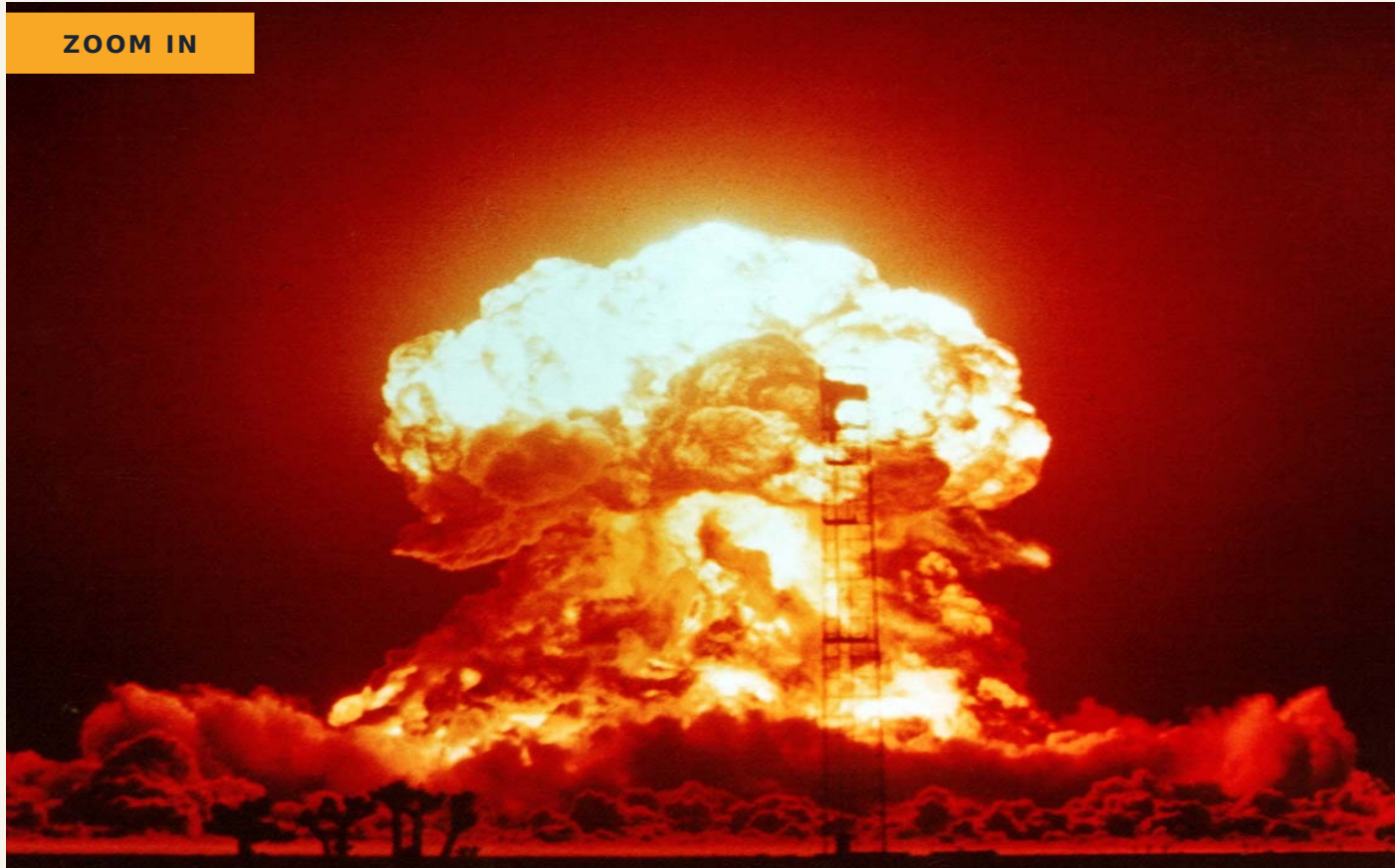
Fear of nuclear war reshaped American life — as both superpowers built atomic arsenals, Americans lived under the shadow of sudden annihilation, and “duck and cover” drills brought the fear into schools.

KEY POINT

Fear of nuclear war reshaped American life — as both superpowers built atomic arsenals, Americans lived under the shadow of sudden annihilation, and “duck and cover” drills brought the fear into schools.

Stockpiling and testing fueled debate — the growing nuclear arsenal and open-air atomic testing raised alarm over fallout and safety, sparking arguments over how far the arms race should go.

ZOOM IN



Sputnik turned fear into a technology race — the 1957 Soviet launch of Sputnik, the first satellite, shocked Americans into fearing they had fallen behind, spurring new investment in science and defense.

KEY POINT

Sputnik turned fear into a technology race — the 1957 Soviet launch of Sputnik, the first satellite, shocked Americans into fearing they had fallen behind, spurring new investment in science and defense.

Read the Federal Civil Defense pamphlet — weigh who produced it and why before you read the message.

WHO

Federal Civil Defense Administration

WHEN

1951

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Civil Defense Pamphlet

Federal Civil Defense Administration · 1951

"You can survive an atomic bomb attack! But you must know what to do. Duck and cover at the flash of light. Stay away from windows. If outdoors, lie flat on the ground. Have an emergency kit ready. Build a fallout shelter in your basement or backyard. With proper preparation, you and your family can survive."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.64:

Defense and science industries funded by the arms and space race, and the government, which used civil defense to rally the public.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.64:

Ordinary Americans living in constant fear of nuclear war, and communities exposed to fallout from open-air atomic testing.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.64:

The federal government and civil-defense agencies that set testing, stockpiling, and preparedness policy for the nuclear age.

Anchor: Civil Defense Pamphlet, Federal Civil Defense Administration, 1951 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Nuclear Fears

En español: *Miedos Nucleares*

WHAT IT MEANS

The widespread anxiety in 1950s America about nuclear war with the Soviet Union, driven by atomic bomb tests, the arms race, and fear of sudden nuclear annihilation.

Fallout Shelters

En español: *Refugios Antibombas*

WHAT IT MEANS

Underground or reinforced structures designed to protect people from radioactive fallout after a nuclear explosion, widely promoted and built during the 1950s as Cold War tensions escalated.

Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD)

En español: *Destrucción Mutua Asegurada*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War doctrine that nuclear war between the U.S. and Soviet Union would result in complete annihilation of both sides, theoretically preventing either from starting a war.

Check your understanding

Why did Sputnik shock Americans and change U.S. education and defense policies?

- A** Sputnik had no significant impact on American policy, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which does not align with the documented historical record
- B** It demonstrated Soviet technological capability and potential ICBM threat, spurring the space race, increased science education funding, and heightened fears of nuclear vulnerability
- C** Americans celebrated Soviet space achievements, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- D** Sputnik only affected the space program, not other policies, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.65

U.S.-Cuba Relations

TN STANDARD

US.65 – Describe the relationship between Cuba and the U.S., including the Bay of Pigs Invasion and Cuban Missile Crisis.

I CAN

I can describe the relationship between Cuba and the U.S., including the Bay of Pigs Invasion and Cuban Missile Crisis.

A communist Cuba emerged 90 miles away — Fidel Castro's 1959 revolution created a Soviet-aligned communist state close to U.S. shores, alarming Washington and reshaping Cold War strategy in the hemisphere.

KEY POINT

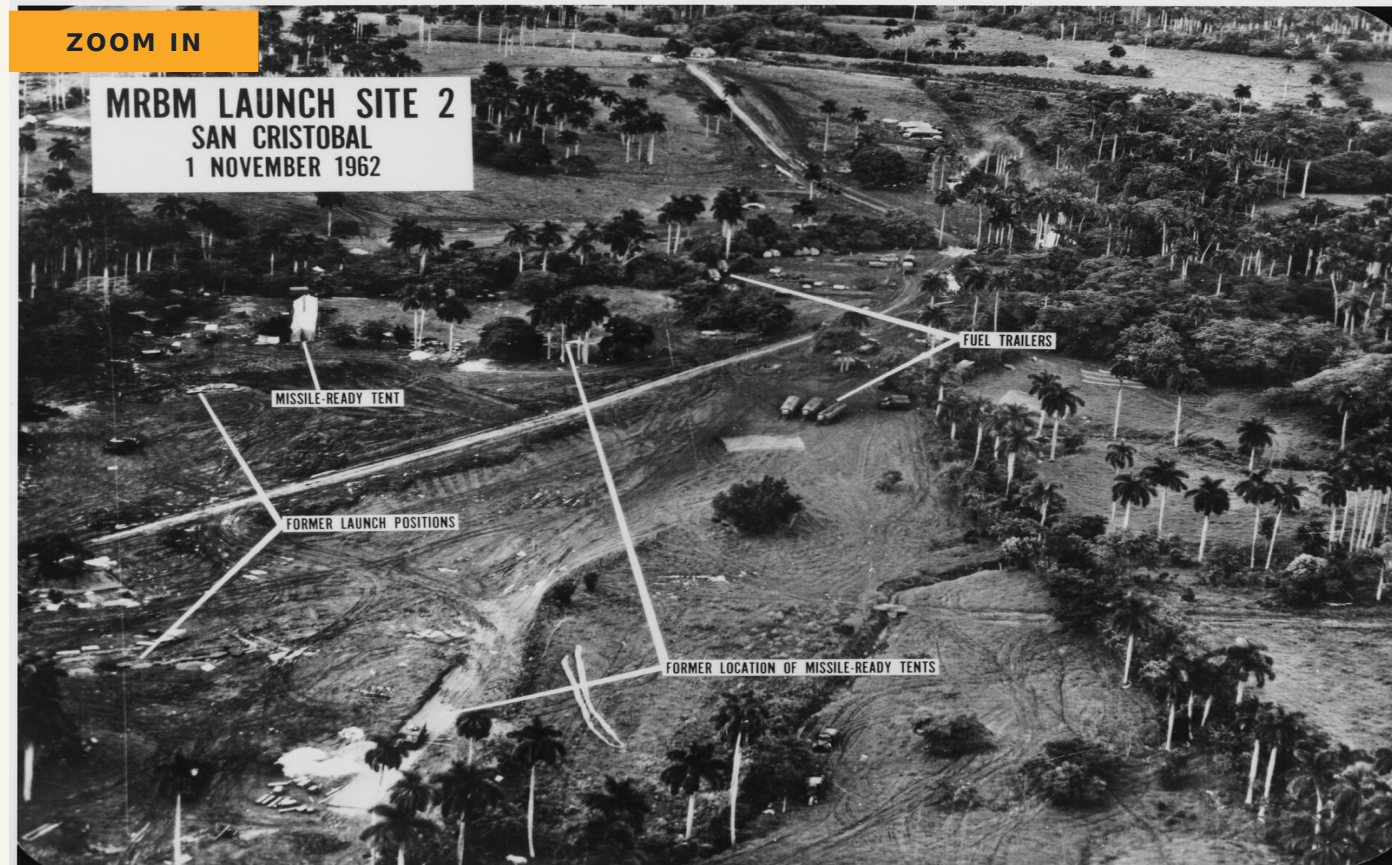
A communist Cuba emerged 90 miles away — Fidel Castro's 1959 revolution created a Soviet-aligned communist state close to U.S. shores, alarming Washington and reshaping Cold War strategy in the hemisphere.

The Bay of Pigs invasion failed badly — a 1961 CIA-backed landing of Cuban exiles collapsed, humiliating the Kennedy administration and pushing Cuba even closer to the Soviet Union.

KEY POINT

The Bay of Pigs invasion failed badly — a 1961 CIA-backed landing of Cuban exiles collapsed, humiliating the Kennedy administration and pushing Cuba even closer to the Soviet Union.

The Cuban Missile Crisis brought the world to the brink — the 1962 discovery of Soviet nuclear missiles in Cuba triggered a tense standoff that ended when the USSR withdrew the missiles and the U.S. pledged not to invade Cuba.



US.65 · Cuban Missile Crisis (1962)

Read Kennedy's Cuban Missile Crisis Address — note the speaker, date, and purpose before you weigh his words.

WHO

President John F. Kennedy

WHEN

October 22, 1962

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Cuban Missile Crisis Address

President John F. Kennedy · October 22, 1962

"Within the past week, unmistakable evidence has established the fact that a series of offensive missile sites is now in preparation on that imprisoned island. The purpose of these bases can be none other than to provide a nuclear strike capability against the Western Hemisphere... It shall be the policy of this Nation to regard any nuclear missile launched from Cuba against any nation in the Western Hemisphere as an attack by the Soviet Union on the United States, requiring a full retaliatory response upon the Soviet Union."

[John F. Kennedy Presidential Library](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.65:

The United States, which forced the missiles' removal, and Cuba, which won a U.S. pledge not to invade the island.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.65:

A world brought to the edge of nuclear war, and Cuban exiles abandoned at the Bay of Pigs during the failed invasion.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.65:

President Kennedy and Soviet Premier Khrushchev, whose negotiations resolved the standoff, and Castro, who allied Cuba with the USSR.

Anchor: Cuban Missile Crisis Address, President John F. Kennedy, October 22, 1962 (John F. Kennedy Presidential Library)

Words you need before we read

Cuban Missile Crisis

En español: *Cuban Missile Crisis*

WHAT IT MEANS

The thirteen-day 1962 confrontation between the United States and the Soviet Union over Soviet nuclear missiles installed in Cuba, widely regarded as the closest the Cold War came to full-scale nuclear war.

Brinkmanship

En español: *Política al Borde del Abismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War diplomatic strategy of pushing dangerous situations to the edge of war to force the other side to back down, associated with Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in the 1950s.

Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD)

En español: *Destrucción Mutua Asegurada*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War doctrine that nuclear war between the U.S. and Soviet Union would result in complete annihilation of both sides, theoretically preventing either from starting a war.

Check your understanding

Why did the Bay of Pigs invasion fail and what were its consequences?

- A** The invasion succeeded in overthrowing Castro, but this fails to account for the broader historical context
- B** The invasion was never actually attempted, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- C** Kennedy's withdrawal of air support doomed the invasion, humiliating the U.S. and pushing Castro closer to Soviet protection
- D** The failure had no long-term consequences, which does not align with the documented historical record

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.66

Vietnam War Causes, Course, and Consequences

TN STANDARD

US.66 – Describe the causes, course, and consequences of the Vietnam War, including: Geneva Accords, Gulf of Tonkin Resolution, Tet Offensive, Ho Chi Minh, Bombing of Cambodia, Napalm and Agent Orange, Vietnamization.

I CAN

I can describe the causes, course, and consequences of the Vietnam War, including the Geneva Accords, Gulf of Tonkin Resolution, Tet Offensive, Ho Chi Minh, bombing of Cambodia, napalm and Agent Orange, and Vietnamization.

The Geneva Accords split Vietnam and set the stage — the 1954 accords divided Vietnam at the 17th Parallel after French defeat, and Ho Chi Minh's communist North faced a U.S.-backed South.

KEY POINT

The Geneva Accords split Vietnam and set the stage — the 1954 accords divided Vietnam at the 17th Parallel after French defeat, and Ho Chi Minh's communist North faced a U.S.-backed South.

The Gulf of Tonkin opened the door to escalation — the 1964 Gulf of Tonkin Resolution gave President Johnson broad authority to expand U.S. involvement, leading to a massive commitment of American troops.

ZOOM IN



US.66 · Gulf of Tonkin & U.S. Escalation

The Tet Offensive shattered confidence in the war — the 1968 surprise attacks by North Vietnam and the Viet Cong, though militarily repelled, turned American public opinion sharply against a war that seemed unwinnable.

KEY POINT

The Tet Offensive shattered confidence in the war — the 1968 surprise attacks by North Vietnam and the Viet Cong, though militarily repelled, turned American public opinion sharply against a war that seemed unwinnable.

Read the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution — identify who passed it, when, and why before you analyze the source.

WHO

U.S. Congress

WHEN

August 7, 1964

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Gulf of Tonkin Resolution

U.S. Congress · August 7, 1964

"The Congress approves and supports the determination of the President, as Commander in Chief, to take all necessary measures to repel any armed attack against the forces of the United States and to prevent further aggression... The United States is, therefore, prepared, as the President determines, to take all necessary steps, including the use of armed force."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.66:

North Vietnam, which ultimately unified the country under communism, and defense contractors who profited from the long war.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.66:

Millions of Vietnamese and over 58,000 American troops killed, and a divided American public scarred by a costly, controversial war.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.66:

Presidents Johnson and Nixon and Congress, whose Gulf of Tonkin Resolution authorized the escalation of U.S. involvement.

Anchor: Gulf of Tonkin Resolution, U.S. Congress, August 7, 1964 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Korean War

En español: *Guerra de Corea*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1950-1953 conflict in which communist North Korea (backed by China and the Soviet Union) invaded South Korea, prompting U.S.-led UN intervention in the first major "hot war" of the Cold War era.

Domino Theory

En español: *Teoría del Dominó*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Check your understanding

Why did the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution give President Johnson broad war powers without a formal declaration?

- A** Congress formally declared war on North Vietnam, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- B** Johnson never received congressional authorization, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C** The resolution only authorized economic sanctions, which represents a common misconception about the period, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- D** The resolution authorized the president to use military force to assist Southeast Asian nations, effectively bypassing the constitutional requirement for a war declaration

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.67 Presidential Vietnam Policies

TN STANDARD

US.67 – Compare the policies and practices of Presidents John F. Kennedy, Lyndon Johnson, and Richard Nixon and their impacts on the continuation of the Vietnam War.

I CAN

I can compare the policies and practices of Presidents Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon and their impacts on the continuation of the Vietnam War.

Kennedy answered with “flexible response” — rejecting all-or-nothing nuclear threats, Kennedy sent military advisers and Special Forces to South Vietnam, expanding U.S. commitment through limited, adaptable intervention.

KEY POINT

Kennedy answered with “flexible response” — rejecting all-or-nothing nuclear threats, Kennedy sent military advisers and Special Forces to South Vietnam, expanding U.S. commitment through limited, adaptable intervention.

Johnson escalated to a full American war — after the Gulf of Tonkin, Johnson committed hundreds of thousands of ground troops and launched sustained bombing, Americanizing the conflict in Vietnam.

KEY POINT

Johnson escalated to a full American war — after the Gulf of Tonkin, Johnson committed hundreds of thousands of ground troops and launched sustained bombing, Americanizing the conflict in Vietnam.

Nixon's Vietnamization sought an exit — Nixon shifted combat to South Vietnamese forces while withdrawing U.S. troops, aiming for “peace with honor” as the war wound down amid mounting protest.

KEY POINT

Nixon's Vietnamization sought an exit — Nixon shifted combat to South Vietnamese forces while withdrawing U.S. troops, aiming for “peace with honor” as the war wound down amid mounting protest.

Read Nixon's "Silent Majority" Speech — note the speaker, date, and purpose before you weigh his words.

WHO

President Richard Nixon

WHEN

November 3, 1969

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Nixon's "Silent Majority" Speech

President Richard Nixon · November 3, 1969

"We have adopted a plan which we have worked out in cooperation with the South Vietnamese for the complete withdrawal of all U.S. combat ground forces... As South Vietnamese forces become stronger, the rate of American withdrawal can become greater... I call it the Nixon Doctrine."

[Richard Nixon Presidential Library](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.67:

Presidents who used Vietnam policy to project resolve, and, in the end, North Vietnam, which outlasted successive U.S. strategies.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.67:

American soldiers and Vietnamese civilians caught in escalating war, and a public increasingly distrustful of its leaders.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.67:

Presidents Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon, whose differing strategies — flexible response, escalation, and Vietnamization — directed the war.

Anchor: Nixon's "Silent Majority" Speech, President Richard Nixon, November 3, 1969 (Richard Nixon Presidential Library)

Words you need before we read

Domino Theory

En español: *Teoría del Dominó*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Cold War

En español: *Guerra Fría*

WHAT IT MEANS

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Check your understanding

Why did Johnson's massive escalation fail to achieve victory in Vietnam?

- A** Despite 543,000 troops and extensive bombing, conventional military power proved ineffective against guerrilla warfare and a determined enemy fighting on their homeland
- B** Johnson never significantly escalated American involvement, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C** American forces won every major engagement, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D** Congress prevented Johnson from adequate escalation, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, which represents a common misconception about this historical period

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.68

Vietnam War Home Front Impact

TN STANDARD

US.68 – Evaluate the impact of the Vietnam War on the home front, including: the anti-war movement, draft by lottery, and the role of television and the media.

I CAN

I can evaluate the impact of the Vietnam War on the home front, including the anti-war movement, draft by lottery, and the role of television and the media.

An anti-war movement swept campuses and cities — as casualties mounted, students, activists, and eventually much of the public protested the war, dividing the nation and challenging government policy.



The draft lottery deepened resentment — the draft, run by lottery, fell heavily on young and poorer Americans, fueling anger, resistance, and debate over who bore the burden of the war.

KEY POINT

The draft lottery deepened resentment — the draft, run by lottery, fell heavily on young and poorer Americans, fueling anger, resistance, and debate over who bore the burden of the war.

Television made Vietnam the “living-room war” — nightly TV coverage brought the war’s violence into American homes, widening the “credibility gap” between official claims and what the public could see.

KEY POINT

Television made Vietnam the “living-room war” — nightly TV coverage brought the war’s violence into American homes, widening the “credibility gap” between official claims and what the public could see.

Read the SDS Anti-War Protest Statement — consider who wrote it and why before you weigh its words.

WHO

Students for a Democratic Society

WHEN

1965

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Anti-War Protest Statement

Students for a Democratic Society · 1965

"We are here today to protest a war that is immoral, illegal, and unjust. Our government sends young men to die in a country they cannot find on a map, for reasons that have never been honestly explained. We demand an end to the draft. We demand that our government bring our brothers home. This is not our war."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.68:

The anti-war and youth movements that gained political voice, and journalists whose coverage shaped public understanding of the war.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.68:

Draftees, especially the young and poor, sent to fight, and a nation deeply divided between supporters and opponents of the war.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.68:

The federal government, which ran the draft and set war policy, and citizens and the press, who shaped opinion through protest and coverage.

Anchor: Anti-War Protest Statement, Students for a Democratic Society, 1965 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Youth Culture

En español: *Cultura Juvenil*

WHAT IT MEANS

The distinct set of tastes, music, fashion, and attitudes that emerged among American teenagers in the 1950s and 1960s, marking youth as a powerful new social and economic force.

Rock 'n' Roll

En español: *Rock 'n' Roll*

WHAT IT MEANS

A revolutionary music genre that emerged in the 1950s, blending rhythm and blues with country music, challenging racial barriers and traditional values while becoming the soundtrack of youth rebellion.

Elvis Presley

En español: *Elvis Presley*

WHAT IT MEANS

Tennessee-born musician who became the "King of Rock 'n' Roll" in the 1950s, bringing Black rhythm and blues to white mainstream audiences and revolutionizing popular music and youth culture.

Check your understanding

What changes did the draft lottery system make and how did it contribute to the 26th Amendment?

- A** The lottery eliminated all draft inequities, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- B** While the lottery added some fairness, class bias remained through deferments, and opposition to drafting 18-year-olds who couldn't vote led to the 26th Amendment
- C** The draft had no connection to voting rights, but the historical record tells a more complex story and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- D** The lottery was never actually implemented, which does not align with the documented historical record when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😊 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.69

Space Race Competition

TN STANDARD

US.69 – Describe the competition between the U.S. and Soviet Union for superiority in space.

I CAN

I can describe the competition between the U.S. and Soviet Union for superiority in space.

Cold War rivalry launched the Space Race — the superpowers competed to prove the superiority of their systems through spaceflight, making rockets and satellites a front in the larger Cold War contest.



US.69 · Motivations & Response to Sputnik

Each side raced past new milestones — the Soviets launched Sputnik and the first human into orbit, spurring the U.S. to create NASA and pour resources into catching up and pulling ahead.

KEY POINT

Each side raced past new milestones — the Soviets launched Sputnik and the first human into orbit, spurring the U.S. to create NASA and pour resources into catching up and pulling ahead.

The Moon landing proved American leadership — the 1969 Apollo 11 landing fulfilled Kennedy's pledge, giving the U.S. a symbolic Cold War victory and a lasting demonstration of its scientific power.

KEY POINT

The Moon landing proved American leadership — the 1969 Apollo 11 landing fulfilled Kennedy's pledge, giving the U.S. a symbolic Cold War victory and a lasting demonstration of its scientific power.

Read Kennedy's Moon Landing Speech — identify the speaker, date, and purpose before you analyze his words.

WHO

President John F. Kennedy

WHEN

May 25, 1961

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Moon Landing Speech

President John F. Kennedy · May 25, 1961

"I believe that this nation should commit itself to achieving the goal, before this decade is out, of landing a man on the Moon and returning him safely to the Earth. No single space project in this period will be more impressive to mankind, or more important for the long-range exploration of space; and none will be so difficult or expensive to accomplish."

[John F. Kennedy Presidential Library](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.69:

The United States, which won prestige with the Moon landing, and science, education, and technology industries funded by the race.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.69:

Taxpayers who funded enormous space programs, and critics who argued the money could have addressed pressing problems at home.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.69:

Presidents Kennedy and Johnson and Congress, who committed the nation to NASA and the goal of landing on the Moon.

Anchor: Moon Landing Speech, President John F. Kennedy, May 25, 1961 (John F. Kennedy Presidential Library)

Words you need before we read

Space Race

En español: *Carrera Espacial*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War competition between the United States and Soviet Union for supremacy in space exploration, driven by national pride, technological advancement, and military implications of rocket technology.

Sputnik

En español: *Sputnik*

WHAT IT MEANS

The world's first artificial satellite, launched by the Soviet Union on October 4, 1957, shocking Americans and triggering fears about Soviet technological superiority and the "missile gap."

Arms Race

En español: *Carrera Armamentista*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War competition between the United States and Soviet Union to develop increasingly powerful nuclear weapons and delivery systems, with each side trying to achieve military superiority.

Check your understanding

How did early Soviet successes like Sputnik and Gagarin shock Americans and change education policy?

- A** Soviet achievements had no impact on American policy, which does not align with the documented historical record, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- B** Americans were not concerned about Soviet space achievements, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C** They suggested Soviet technological superiority, prompting NASA's creation, the National Defense Education Act, and massive investment in science education
- D** Education policy remained unchanged after Sputnik, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion and fails to account for key developments in the broader context

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.70

Cold War Détente & the Fall of the Berlin Wall

TN STANDARD

US.70 – Explain developments that eased tensions during the Cold War, including: President Richard Nixon's détente, SALT Treaties, President Ronald Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev's INF Treaty, The fall of the Berlin Wall.

I CAN

I can explain developments that eased tensions during the Cold War, including Nixon's détente, SALT Treaties, Reagan and Gorbachev's INF Treaty, and the fall of the Berlin Wall.

Nixon's détente eased Cold War tensions — through diplomacy with the Soviet Union and China, Nixon sought to reduce the risk of nuclear war and manage the superpower rivalry through negotiation.

KEY POINT

Nixon's détente eased Cold War tensions — through diplomacy with the Soviet Union and China, Nixon sought to reduce the risk of nuclear war and manage the superpower rivalry through negotiation.

The SALT treaties limited nuclear arms — the Strategic Arms Limitation Talks produced the first agreements capping the superpowers' nuclear arsenals, a landmark step in slowing the arms race.

KEY POINT

The SALT treaties limited nuclear arms — the Strategic Arms Limitation Talks produced the first agreements capping the superpowers' nuclear arsenals, a landmark step in slowing the arms race.

Reagan, Gorbachev, and the Wall's fall ended the era — renewed U.S. pressure and Gorbachev's reforms led to the 1989 fall of the Berlin Wall, symbolizing the collapse of communist control in Eastern Europe.

ZOOM IN



US.70 · Reagan-Gorbachev & the Fall of the Berlin Wall

Read Reagan's Remarks at the Brandenburg Gate — note the speaker, date, and purpose before you weigh his words.

WHO

President Ronald Reagan

WHEN

June 12, 1987

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Remarks at the Brandenburg Gate

President Ronald Reagan · June 12, 1987

"General Secretary Gorbachev, if you seek peace, if you seek prosperity for the Soviet Union and Eastern Europe, if you seek liberalization: Come here to this gate! Mr. Gorbachev, open this gate! Mr. Gorbachev, tear down this wall!"

[Ronald Reagan Presidential Library](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.70:

The peoples of Eastern Europe freed from communist control, and the United States, which emerged as the sole superpower as the Cold War ended.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.70:

The Soviet Union, which collapsed as its bloc dissolved, and populations facing upheaval as communist economies and states broke apart.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.70:

Leaders like Nixon, Reagan, and Gorbachev, whose détente, arms treaties, and reforms steered the Cold War toward its end.

Anchor: Remarks at the Brandenburg Gate, President Ronald Reagan, June 12, 1987 (Ronald Reagan Presidential Library)

Words you need before we read

Iron Curtain

En español: *Cortina de Hierro*

WHAT IT MEANS

Winston Churchill's metaphor for the political and military barrier dividing Soviet-controlled Eastern Europe from Western Europe after World War II.

Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Cold War

En español: *Guerra Fría*

WHAT IT MEANS

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Check your understanding

What significance did the SALT Treaties have for nuclear arms control?

- A** SALT treaties had no practical effect, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- B** SALT treaties eliminated all nuclear weapons, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- C** Only the Soviet Union agreed to limitations, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D** They were the first successful nuclear arms agreements, limiting missiles and establishing verification procedures that demonstrated both nations wanted to avoid nuclear war

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.